

ATTRACTION: Akshayvat

ALTERNATIVE NAMES:

Akshay Vat

LOCATION:

Maranpur, Gaya

DISTRICT / REGION:

Gaya

CATEGORY:

Religious Site

OVERVIEW:

Akshayvat, meaning the everlasting and indestructible "Banyan Tree", is a profoundly sacred site in Maranpur, Gaya. The tree holds immense religious significance, especially for the Pinda Daan rituals, which commence at the Falgu River and conclude here. According to Hindu mythology, the tree received a boon from Sita rendering it immortal. Additionally, the Ved Puran states that Lord Krishna resides under its shadow, and it will survive even when the entire world is submerged in water.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION:

Akshayvat is a massive, indestructible banyan tree situated in Maranpur, Gaya. It marks the culmination point of the sacred Pinda Daan rituals that begin at the Falgu River. This location is central to Hindu pilgrimage in Gaya, revered due to its eternal nature granted by a mythological boon. The area around the tree serves as a major gathering point for devotees performing rites for their ancestors.

HISTORICAL OR CULTURAL SIGNIFICANCE:

The tree is of paramount importance in the performance of Pinda Daan, the Hindu ritual of paying homage to deceased ancestors. Its enduring presence has made it a focal point for pilgrims for centuries.

LEGENDS, STORIES, OR TRADITIONS:

According to legend, the tree received a boon from Sita, making it immortal and incapable of dying. The Ved Puran states that Lord Krishna stays under its shadow, and when the whole world ultimately drowns in water, this tree will survive due to Sita's boon. It marks the endpoint of the Pinda Daan ritual that begins at the Falgu River.

KEY HIGHLIGHTS:

- The indestructible and everlasting Banyan tree.
- The concluding site for the sacred Pinda Daan rituals.
- Associated with Hindu deities Sita and Lord Krishna.

VISITOR INFORMATION:

Best Time To Visit: October to March

Opening Hours: 06:00 AM - 08:30 PM

Entry Fee: Not Mentioned

Duration Recommended: Not Mentioned

Photography: Videography & Photography Allowed

Accessibility Information: Not Mentioned

FACILITIES:

- Parking
- Drinking Water

TRANSPORTATION:

Nearest Airport: Gaya International Airport

Distance From Airport: 09 Kms

Nearest Railway Station: Gaya Junction

Distance From Railway Station: 05 Kms

Nearest Bus Stand: Govt. Bus stand near Gandhi Maidan, Gaya

Distance From Bus Stand: 03 Kms

Road Connectivity: Not Mentioned

Nearest Tourist Information Centre: Tourist Information Centre, Gaya Junction (05 Kms)

Nearest Police Station: Vishnupad Police Station (01 Km), Mob: 9431092838

Nearest Medical Facility: Jay Prakash Narayan Hospital, Gaya, Mob: 9470003263; Anugrah Narayan

Magadh Medical Collage & Hospital, Gaya Ph: 0631-221074

NEARBY ATTRACTIONS:

- Mahabodhi Mandir (17 Kms)
- Vishnu Pad Mandir (02 Kms)
- 80 feet Buddha statue (17 Kms)
- Pretshila (12 Kms)
- Manglagauri Mandir (2.5 Kms)

FESTIVALS AND EVENTS:

Not Mentioned

LOCAL CULTURE AND EXPERIENCES:

Performing or observing the Pinda Daan rituals.

LOCAL FOOD AND CUISINE:

Not Mentioned

SHOPPING AND SOUVENIRS:

Not Mentioned

ACCOMMODATION:

- Vishnu View Hotel (Mob: 9608556289)
- Ajatsatru Hotel (Mob: 9798881223)
- Hotel Mantra Regency (Mob: 9973357885)
- Hotel Royal View (Mob: 9431224222)

HOTELS:

- Vishnu View Hotel
- Ajatsatru Hotel
- Hotel Mantra Regency
- Hotel Royal View

LOCAL GUIDES:

- Ravi Kumar, Mob: 9810863603
- Dhiraj Kumar, Mob: 9958343625
- Gautam Kumar, Mob: 9934058927
- Sanjeet Kumar Singh, Mob: 9955216797
- Raju Kumar, Mob: 9934290978

TRAVEL OPERATORS:

- Gupta Tour & Travels (Mob: 8507192638)
- Vishal Tour & Travels (Mob: 9006169000)
- Maa Vaishnavi Tour & Travels (Mob: 8083329781)
- Surya Services (Mob: 9431094940)

IMPORTANT FACTS:

- Meaning of Akshayvat is everlasting, indestructible Banyan Tree.
- Pinda Daan starts from Falgu River and finishes at Akshay Vat.
- Located in Maranpur, Gaya.

RETRIEVAL SUMMARY:

Akshayvat, located in Maranpur, Gaya, is an everlasting, indestructible Banyan tree of immense religious significance in Hinduism. It is the concluding site for Pinda Daan rituals, which commence at the Falgu River. According to mythology, the tree is immortal due to a boon from Sita, and Lord Krishna is believed to reside under its shadow. The site is open to visitors from 06:00 AM to 08:30 PM, ideally visited between October and March. It is well connected, lying 9 km from Gaya International Airport and 5 km from Gaya Junction. Nearby sites include Vishnu Pad Mandir (2 km) and Manglagauri Mandir (2.5 km).

QUESTION-ANSWER FACTS:

Q: What does Akshay Vat mean?

A: It means the everlasting, indestructible Banyan Tree.

Q: Why is Akshayvat important in Gaya?

A: It is a highly significant place where the Pinda Daan rituals, which start at the Falgu River, conclude.

Q: According to mythology, why is the Akshayvat tree immortal?

A: It received a boon from Sita that it cannot die, and it will survive even when the whole world drowns in water.

Q: Which Hindu deity is believed to stay under the shadow of Akshayvat?

A: According to the Ved Puran, Lord Krishna stays under its shadow.

Q: What are the closest transport facilities to Akshayvat?

A: Govt. Bus stand near Gandhi Maidan (03 Kms), Gaya Junction (05 Kms), and Gaya International Airport (09 Kms).

KEYWORDS:

Akshayvat, Maranpur, Gaya, Banyan Tree, Pinda Daan, Falgu River, Sita, Lord Krishna, Ved Puran, Hindu Pilgrimage, Everlasting Tree